

LAYER 4

Chains

Multi-step sequences that test every rule you have learned. The ultimate test of understanding.

THE PRISMATIC SYSTEM

What Is a Chain?

A Chain combines three or more elements in sequence from left to right. At each step, you Bind, Fold, and convert the result before moving to the next element.

The 5-Step Chain Procedure:

Step 1: Bind the first two elements using the correct type-dependent rule.

Step 2: Fold the result.

Step 3: The folded result becomes a GLYPH with that value.

Step 4: Bind this new Glyph with the next element in the chain.

Step 5: Fold again. Repeat until all elements are consumed.



Intermediate results ALWAYS become Glyphs. Use the GLYPH row of the binding table for the next step.

Worked Example: Glyph₁ → Ring₄ → Shard₂

Let's trace through a complete chain step by step.

Step 1 — Bind: $\text{Glyph}_1 \oplus \text{Ring}_4 = 1 \times 8 = 8$ (Glyph-Ring: multiply)

Step 2 — Fold: $\Delta(8) = 8 + 3 = 11$ (positive < 10, add 3)

Step 3 — Convert: Result 11 becomes Glyph₁₁

Step 4 — Bind: $\text{Glyph}_{11} \oplus \text{Shard}_2 = 4 - 11 = -7$ (Glyph-Shard: S-G)

Step 5 — Fold: $\Delta(-7) = |-7| + 5 = 12$ (negative: |value| + 5)

Final result: 12

Worked Example: Shard₃ → Ring₂ → Glyph₁

Another chain with different element types:

Step 1 — Bind: $\text{Shard}_3 \oplus \text{Ring}_2 = 9 - 4 = 5$ (Shard-Ring: S-R)

Step 2 — Fold: $\Delta(5) = 5 + 3 = 8$ (positive < 10, add 3)

Step 3 — Convert: Result 8 becomes Glyph₈

Step 4 — Bind: $\text{Glyph}_8 \oplus \text{Glyph}_1 = 8 + 1 = 9$ (same-type: add)

Step 5 — Fold: $\Delta(9) = 9 + 3 = 12$ (positive < 10, add 3)

Final result: 12

Notice in Step 4: the intermediate Glyph₈ binds with Glyph₁. Both are Glyphs now, so we use same-type binding (add). This is why the “becomes a Glyph” rule matters.

Chain Practice

Try this chain yourself before looking at the answer:

Chain: Ring₃ → Glyph₂ → Shard₁

Step 1: Ring₃ ⊕ Glyph₂ = ? (what rule?)

Step 2: Δ(?) = ?

Step 3: Becomes Glyph with what value?

Step 4: That Glyph ⊕ Shard₁ = ? (what rule?)

Step 5: Δ(?) = ?

Answer: 6+2=8 → Δ(8)=11 → Glyph₁₁ → 1-11=-10 → Δ(-10)=15. Final: 15

Common Mistakes in Chains

The three most frequent errors students make:

 **Mistake 1:** Forgetting to convert the intermediate result to a Glyph. After folding, the result is always a Glyph — use the Glyph row of the binding table for the next step.

 **Mistake 2:** Using the wrong binding rule because of order confusion. The intermediate Glyph is always on the LEFT. So if the next element is a Ring, use Glyph $\oplus$ Ring (multiply), not Ring $\oplus$ Glyph (add).

 **Mistake 3:** Applying the wrong folding rule. Always check the input: is it ≥ 10 ? Is it 1-9? Is it ≤ 0 ? Only one rule applies.

If your chain gives an unexpected result, go back and check each step. One small error cascades through every following step.